

Vanteloq Data Retention and Disposal Policy

ADOPTED POLICY

Approved by the Owner and Security Lead on September 23, 2026. First quarterly review due December 22, 2026.

Document control	Value
Organization	LexEdge Consulting, operating Vanteloq
Policy owner	Hussien Issa, Owner and Security Lead
Version	1.3
Prepared	2026-09-23
Technical baseline reviewed	2026-09-23
Review cycle	Quarterly enforcement review and annual policy review
Proposed first quarterly review	2026-12-22
Proposed next annual review	2027-09-23
Approval status	Approved and adopted

1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines how Vanteloq retains, reviews, deletes, de-identifies, and disposes of consumer, financial, business, authentication, integration, support, and security data. It applies to production databases, private object storage, logs, backups, exports, support systems, connected providers including Plaid, and temporary copies created for an authorized product or security purpose.

Vanteloq keeps identifiable data only while it is needed for a disclosed service purpose, a customer instruction, security, a legal obligation, a dispute, or a documented legal hold. Retention is not indefinite by default. A longer period must have a recorded legal, contractual, or operational basis.

This policy is designed for Vanteloq's current Canadian operations. It must be reassessed before offering the service in a jurisdiction with a different mandatory retention period. It does not replace customer-specific accounting, tax, employment, or legal advice.

2. Governing principles

- 1 Collect and retain only the minimum data needed for an identified and authorized purpose.
- 2 Apply a documented minimum and maximum retention period to each data category.
- 3 Stop new collection when consent or provider authorization is withdrawn.
- 4 Revoke provider access before deleting locally held provider credentials and data when a provider connection exists.
- 5 Delete, securely destroy, or irreversibly de-identify personal information when the purpose and any lawful retention requirement end.
- 6 Preserve only the minimum accounting fields required for an active customer's books or a documented legal duty; remove provider identifiers and unnecessary personal details.
- 7 Record the actor, time, scope, result, and limitation of material deletion and retention actions without copying the deleted content into the audit record.
- 8 Reapply deletion tombstones before a restored backup returns to service.

3. Retention schedule

Data category	Minimum or active period	Maximum or review point	Disposal method
Plaid access tokens, item credentials, cursors, and provider connection secrets	Only while the connection is active and authorized	Remove promptly after verified disconnection, authorization withdrawal, workspace deletion, or loss of lawful purpose	Call Plaid /item/remove when credentials are available, stop synchronization, cryptographically delete encrypted credentials, and clear local connection state
Unreviewed Plaid balances and transactions	While needed for the active reconciliation or cash-analysis purpose	Delete on verified Plaid-data deletion or workspace deletion; review inactive connections quarterly	Delete source and derived financial rows after revocation, subject only to a documented hold
Approved, reconciled, or posted accounting entries derived from Plaid	While needed for the active customer's books and the customer's applicable accounting or tax period	Review at workspace closure and at the end of the customer's instructed retention period	Remove Plaid identifiers, account masks, descriptions, pending links, and provider metadata; retain only the minimum ledger fields the customer must preserve
Plaid consent, withdrawal, deletion, and authorization evidence	Connection life plus 24 months	Quarterly review after the connection closes	Delete or irreversibly de-identify after expiry unless a complaint, investigation, or documented hold requires it
POS, inventory, customer, supplier, and commerce records	While the workspace is active and the records support the customer-selected purpose	Review at least annually and at workspace closure	Export if requested, then delete or de-identify after the applicable customer instruction or legal period
Invoices, receipts, journals, tax support, and other customer accounting records	Customer-selected period; Canadian tax records commonly require at least 6 years from the end of the last tax year to which they relate	Vanteloq's standard supported maximum is 7 years unless the customer records a longer legal requirement	Securely delete after expiry and hold review; remove unnecessary personal details sooner when the accounting record can remain valid without them
User identity, membership, profile, preferences, and private Vanteloq AI history	Active account and membership	Delete after verified account deletion, subject to another active workspace membership or a documented hold	Delete the identity-owned records and de-identify authorship in customer records that must remain
Vanteloq AI conversations and attachments	Until the user deletes the conversation or 90 days after the conversation was last updated	Review on the user's next Vanteloq AI use and during quarterly control review	Delete the scoped messages and attachments; do not retain conversation text as consent evidence
Authentication and integration consent evidence	While relied upon plus up to 24 months after withdrawal or closure	Quarterly review	Retain the minimum version, purpose, actor reference, decision, and timestamp; delete or de-identify the expired record
Nonidentifying account-deletion receipts	24 months	Automatic or quarterly expiry review	Delete after expiry; never include name, email, workspace name, IP address, account mask, or raw provider identifier
Security and administrative audit events	24 months	Quarterly expiry and legal-hold review	Securely delete or de-identify after expiry
Application and request logs	90 days by default	Automated expiry or quarterly verification	Delete after expiry; restricted incident copies follow the incident record period
Support and privacy-request records	24 months after closure	Quarterly review for open disputes or holds	Delete or de-identify after expiry and resolution
Temporary exports, email attachments, scan copies, and generated files	Only while processing or delivery is active	30 days maximum unless a shorter provider lifecycle applies	Automatically expire where supported; otherwise remove during the scheduled review
Rejected, quarantined, or abandoned application uploads	Until classification, retry, or incident review is complete	30 days maximum unless linked to an active incident or protected accounting record	State-aware deletion; never apply a blanket prefix deletion that could remove accepted accounting evidence
Marketing consent and suppression evidence	While consent is relied upon and long enough to answer a compliance question	Review annually	Keep minimum consent or suppression proof only; never reuse it for enrichment

Where another law, customer instruction, contract, provider rule, complaint, or legal hold requires a different period, Vanteloq records the source, data category, period, owner, approval date, review date, and release condition in the retention register.

4. Roles and accountability

The Owner and Security Lead approves the schedule, exceptions, legal holds, and review evidence. System owners configure and test deletion, expiry, revocation, backup, and de-identification controls. Authorized workspace owners control their business records and may request export, disconnection, or deletion through the product or verified support process. Personnel and providers follow least privilege and use retained data only for its recorded purpose. Customers remain responsible for confirming the accounting and tax periods that apply to their records.

5. Plaid consent, disconnection, and deletion

Before Plaid Link is initiated, Vanteloq displays the requested data categories, purposes, policy versions, and deletion route, and records affirmative consent. Only the products and data needed for the selected use are requested. A new purpose or data category requires new or updated authorization.

Withdrawing authorization stops future collection. Disconnection is not permission to retain new Plaid data and is not the same as deleting accounting records that a customer must keep. Any retained record must be limited to its documented accounting or legal purpose and unavailable for unrelated product use.

Plaid deletion is a protected owner action requiring a current authenticated AAL2 session, tenant and finance authorization, exact confirmation, and a rate-limited server request. The process must:

- 1 identify the organization, connection, accounts, credentials, source records, derived records, reports, and audit scope;
- 2 call Plaid `/item/remove` when provider credentials are available;
- 3 stop scheduled synchronization and block further use of the connection;
- 4 delete encrypted credentials, bank-account data, transactions, balances, derived cash metrics, sync cursors, and unauthorized exports within the approved scope;
- 5 de-identify only the minimum ledger or audit evidence that must remain;
- 6 invalidate caches and generated views; and
- 7 record the request, authorization, scope, result, and timestamp without retaining the deleted secret or financial content.

If provider revocation cannot complete, Vanteloq fails closed, blocks further use, retains a restricted retry record, and tells the authorized requester what remains. A failed provider call is not recorded as completed deletion.

6. Account and workspace closure

Verified account deletion removes the login, memberships no longer needed by another workspace, profile, preferences, and private Vanteloq AI history after recent MFA and exact confirmation. Customer records that must remain use de-identified authorship.

A verified workspace-owner deletion checks authority, billing, disputes, exports, and legal holds before deleting the workspace, stored files, active records, credentials, memberships, and eligible authentication accounts. Connected providers are revoked, synchronization stops, and customer-required records should be exported before deletion. A person whose identity is still attached to another workspace is not deleted from that other workspace.

7. Backups, caches, and derived data

Deletion applies to primary records, caches, indexes, generated reports, exports, attachments, and derived analytics. If a provider-managed immutable backup cannot be selectively edited, the deleted record remains inaccessible to normal operations and expires through the provider's documented backup lifecycle. Any restoration must reapply deletion tombstones before the environment returns to service.

Backup capability is not represented as verified until a dated restoration exercise succeeds and evidence is retained. Backup retention must not silently extend normal production access to deleted data.

8. Legal holds and exceptions

Only the Owner and Security Lead may approve a legal hold or retention exception. The record must name the affected data, reason, authority, owner, start date, next review, and release condition. Held data is restricted to the hold purpose. The hold does not suspend deletion of unrelated records. Normal disposal resumes promptly when the hold ends.

An exception does not change the policy silently. It must include a compensating control, target remediation date, and approval. Expired exceptions are escalated at the quarterly review.

9. Secure disposal standards

- Database and object records are deleted through authenticated server-side operations.
- Encryption keys or wrapped credentials are destroyed when cryptographic deletion is used.
- Paper containing restricted information is cross-cut shredded.
- Physical media, if introduced, is sanitized or destroyed using a documented method appropriate to the media and data sensitivity.
- Provider deletion, revocation, or contract termination is recorded.
- Disposal logs record scope and outcome without reproducing personal, financial, or secret content.
- Reuse or disposal of a device requires verified removal of Vanteloq data and credentials.

10. Review, testing, and evidence

The Owner and Security Lead performs and records a quarterly enforcement review. The review must examine configured expiry controls, deletion queues, provider disconnection, stale exports, rejected uploads, backup treatment, legal holds, exceptions, and a sample deletion or de-identification result. The full policy is reviewed annually and after a material product, provider, legal, jurisdictional, or data-use change.

Evidence includes consent and withdrawal records, deletion audit events, provider revocation results, retention-job logs, exception and hold approvals, restore tests, and signed review minutes. A planned control is labeled as planned until dated evidence shows that it operates.

The first quarterly review is due by 2026-12-22 if this policy is approved on 2026-09-23. The next annual review is due by 2027-09-23. If approval occurs later, both dates move to 90 days and 12 months after approval.

11. Legal and provider references

- Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada, PIPEDA Principle 5, Limiting Use, Disclosure, and Retention: https://www.priv.gc.ca/en/privacy-topics/privacy-laws-in-canada/the-personal-information-protection-and-electronic-documents-act-pipeda/p_principle/principles/p_use/
- Office of the Privacy Commissioner of Canada, Personal Information Retention and Disposal, Principles and Best Practices: https://www.priv.gc.ca/en/privacy-topics/privacy-for-businesses/appropriate-handling-of-personal-information/gd_rd_201406/
- Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner of Alberta, PIPA guidance applying the requirement to keep personal information only as long as reasonably required for legal or business purposes: <https://oipc.ab.ca/resource/guidance-for-landlords-and-tenants/>
- Canada Revenue Agency, Electronic Record Keeping, including the general minimum six-year period and restoration expectations for electronic records: <https://www.canada.ca/en/revenue-agency/services/forms-publications/publications/ic05-1/electronic-record-keeping.html>
- Plaid Launch Checklist, including Item removal when a connection is no longer used: <https://plaid.com/docs/launch-checklist/>
- Plaid Items API, /item/remove: <https://plaid.com/docs/api/items/>

12. Approval

This policy becomes an operating requirement only after the owner approves the record below. Approval confirms responsibility for the quarterly review, annual review, exception register, and truthful disclosure of incomplete controls. It is not a legal opinion or a claim that every historical review has already occurred.

Field	Entry
Approved by	Hussien Issa
Title	Owner and Security Lead
Approval date	2026-09-23
Approval method or signature	Electronic owner approval recorded in the Vanteloq project task
First quarterly review due	2026-12-22
Next annual review	2027-09-23

After approval, the policy owner will store the adopted copy in the compliance register, schedule the first quarterly review, update the Plaid questionnaire to reflect the adopted policy, and preserve evidence of each review and exception.